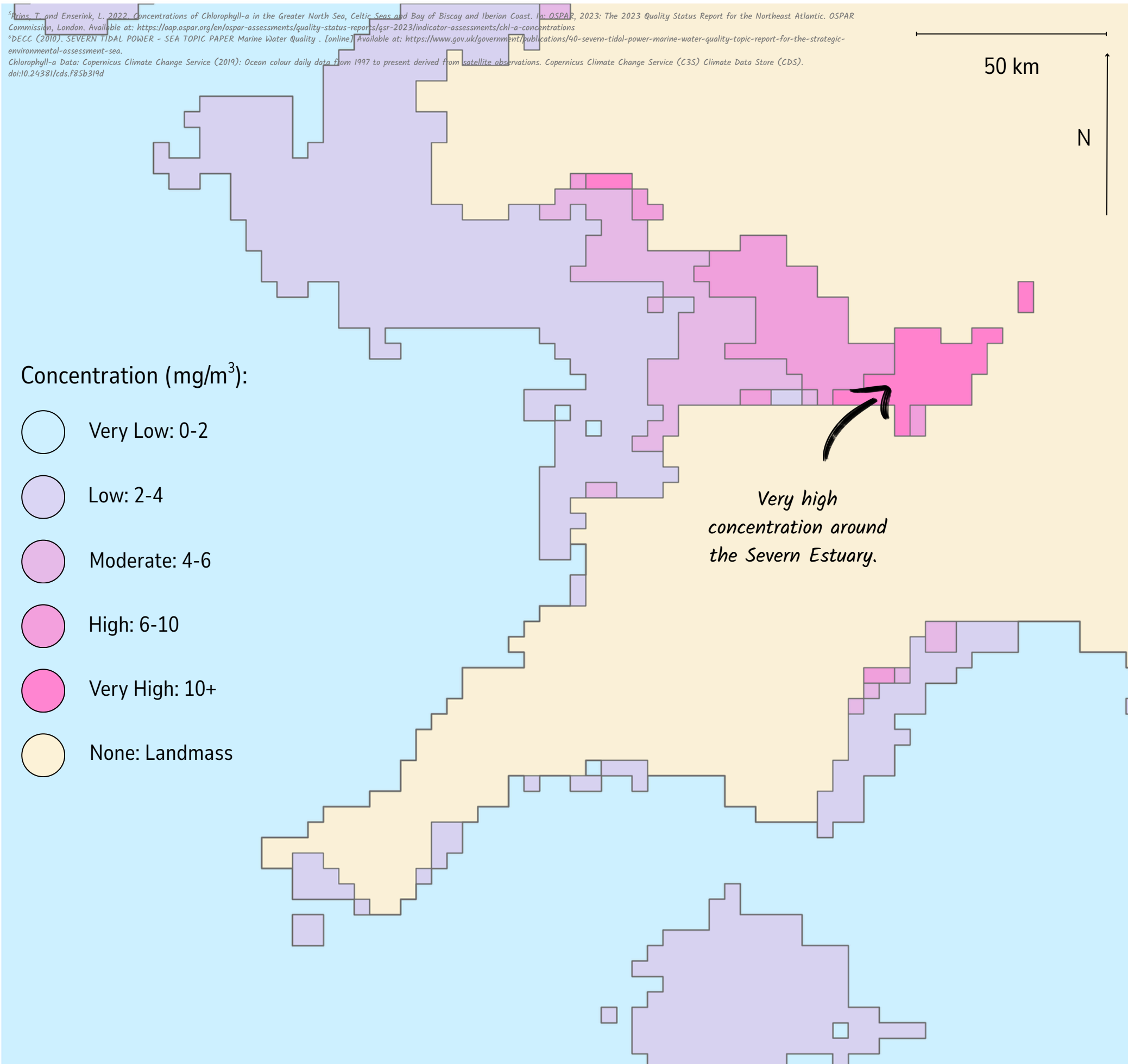




What Feeds the Bloom?

The 90th-percentile summer (May-September) chlorophyll-a concentration from 2015 to 2024 was mapped. Chlorophyll-a is commonly used as a proxy for phytoplankton biomass. At elevated levels, it can indicate eutrophication, which supports jellyfish blooms by increasing food availability⁵.

Most waters fall within the very low chlorophyll-a class, covering 76.8% of the area, while low chlorophyll-a covers 17.9%. Moderate to very high chlorophyll-a zones are much more limited, together covering only 5.3% of the mapped waters.

Very high concentrations can be seen near the Severn Estuary. This area receives some of the UK's highest nitrogen and phosphorus inputs, which can support high phytoplankton productivity⁶.

The high chlorophyll-a zones do not fully align with the jellyfish clusters shown in the previous map. This suggests that eutrophication alone cannot explain bloom locations. Jellyfish distributions are also shaped by processes such as currents, temperature, and salinity.

